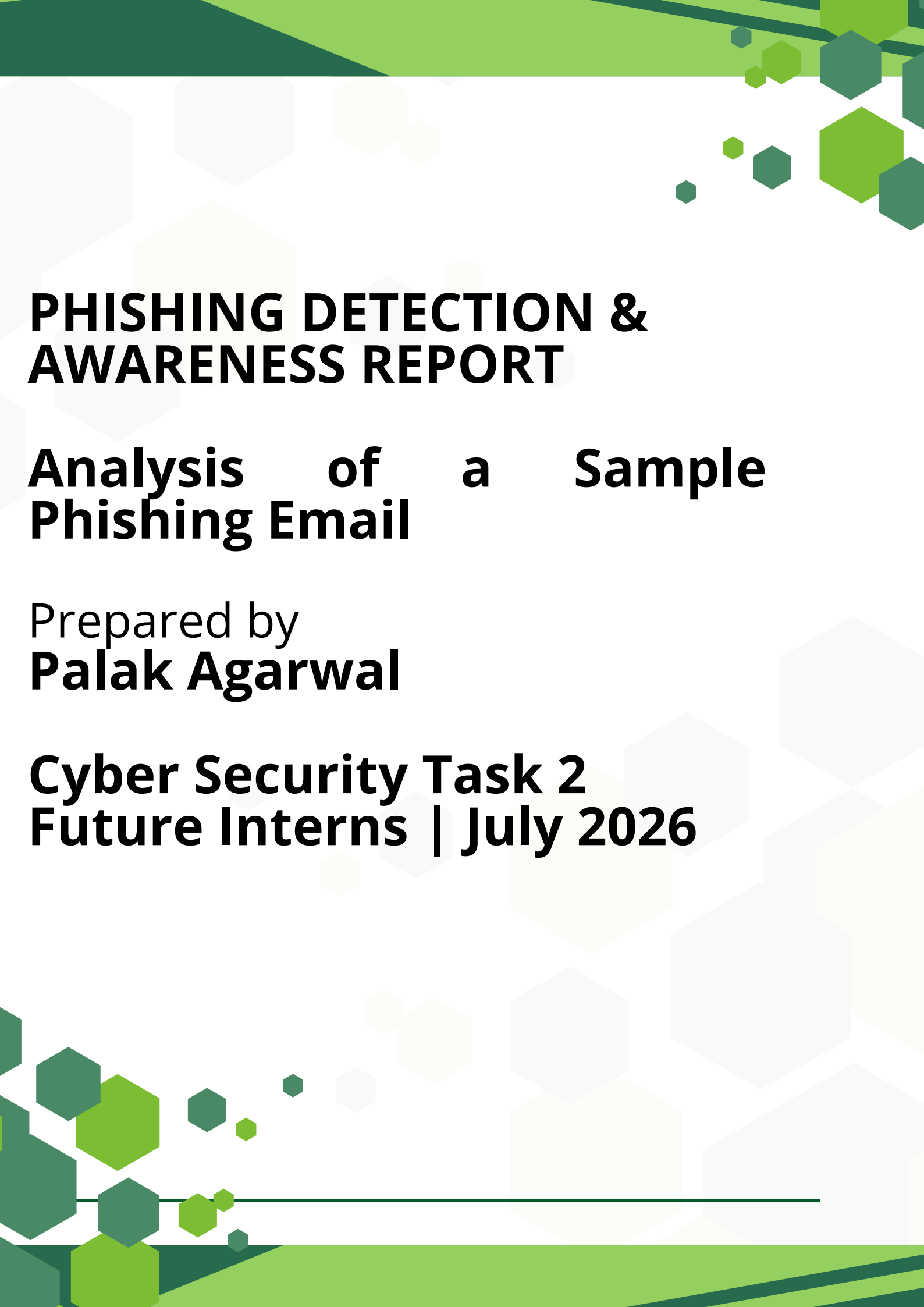




PHISHING DETECTION & AWARENESS REPORT

Analysis of a Sample Phishing Email

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**Cyber Security Task 2
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Objective

This report analyzes a sample phishing email and identifies the warning signs that make it unsafe.

The purpose is to help users recognize suspicious emails, avoid unsafe links, and protect personal or organizational information.

Scope:

- One educational phishing email sample
 - Read-only analysis of the email content and link
 - No interaction with the suspicious link
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Sample Email Analysis

Email Classification: PHISHING — HIGH RISK

Subject:

Urgent: Your Account Will Be Locked

Summary:

The email uses fear and urgency to make the recipient act quickly. It asks the user to verify account details through a suspicious link.

Source:

Educational phishing-email example provided in the Future Interns Cyber Security Task 2 instructions.

Subject: ⚠ Urgent: Your Account Will Be Locked

Email Body:

Dear User,

We noticed suspicious activity on your account.

To avoid account suspension, please verify your details immediately.

👉 Verify Now: [http://secure-account-verify\[.\]com](http://secure-account-verify[.]com)

Failure to verify within 24 hours will result in permanent account lock.

Regards,

Security Team

Key Phishing Indicators

1. Urgent and fear-based language

The email threatens that the account will be locked within 24 hours.

2. Generic greeting

It starts with “Dear User” instead of using the recipient’s name.

3. Suspicious link

The link does not clearly belong to a trusted organization.

4. Pressure to act immediately

It pushes the recipient to click before checking whether the email is genuine.

5. Vague sender identity

It only says “Security Team” without naming a verified organization.

Risk Assessment & Attack Flow

Risk Level: HIGH

Why is it high risk?

- It creates urgency and fear.
- It directs the user to an unverified link.
- It may be designed to steal login credentials or personal information.

How the attack could work:

1. The attacker sends an alarming email.
2. The user clicks the link because of urgency.
3. A fake website may ask for login details.
4. The attacker can misuse the stolen information.

How to Stay Safe from Phishing

DO:

- Check the sender's email address carefully.
- Hover over links before clicking.
- Verify urgent requests through official channels.
- Report suspicious emails.

DON'T:

- Do not click unknown links.
- Do not share passwords, OTPs, or banking details.
- Do not download unexpected attachments.

Final Recommendation:

When in doubt, do not click. Verify first.
